

L-67: TRIBAL INDIA — Comprehensive Class Notes

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Syllabus: 8.1 (Hinduism, Christianity, Buddhism, Islam impacts) | 8.2 (Tribe & Nation State) | Approaches to Tribal Development | 9.1 (Administration, PVTGs, NGOs) | 7.1 (DNTs) | 9.2 (Anthropology in Development) | 9.3 (Communalism)

1. IMPACT OF HINDUISM ON TRIBAL SOCIETIES (8.1)

Overview and Statistics

- More than **90%** of the tribal population in India is directed towards Hinduism; approximately **95%** among total tribal population are Hinduised.
- During British rule, cultural contact between tribal societies and urban areas increased rapidly.
- This significant increase in cultural contact took the form of "**Peasantization**" — a concept given by **N.K. Bose** — whereby tribes shifted from forest-based economies to settled agriculture through Hindu influence.

Hindu Accommodation to Tribal Societies

Hinduism is described as **smooth and more compatible** with tribal cultures. Unlike monotheistic religions, Hinduism's polytheistic and flexible nature allowed tribes to continue with many of their original values while also adopting new ones. This led to a unique process of **unification of religion and tribe** — tribes did not have to abandon their identity to become Hindu.

Key Hinduised tribal groups: Bhils, Bhumij, Gonds, Oraons

Tribe-Caste Continuum

⇒ **Surajit Sinha — Tribe Rajput Continuum (Bhumij tribes):** Sinha studied how Bhumij tribes followed the Rajput Model, adopting Rajput customs, rituals, and clan structures. This process is called the "**Tribe Rajput Continuum**".

The forms of **gotras** among Hinduised tribes are more **totemistic than Vedic** — this is the basis of the **Tribe-Caste Continuum**. The concept explains how tribal and caste societies are not rigid, separate categories but exist along a continuum. Tribes that adopted Hindu practices gradually acquired caste-like features (hierarchy, endogamy, occupational specialization) while retaining some tribal characteristics (totemism, clan-based identity).

Kshatriyaization

- ⇒ **S.K. Srivastav** studied the **Tharu tribe** — one of the tribes that got accepted as Kshatriya.
- ⇒ **D.N. Majumdar** studied the **Khasa tribe** — another group that achieved Kshatriya status.

Tribes like **Tharu** and **Khasa** got themselves accepted as Kshatriya through a process called "**Kshatriyaization**" — a popular form of **Sanskritization** (M.N. Srinivas, 1952). Instead of claiming Brahmin status, these tribes emulated Rajput/Kshatriya lifestyles: adopting sacred thread, hiring Brahmin priests, claiming mythological Rajput ancestry, and giving up practices like meat-eating and alcohol consumption.

Case Study — Bhil Tribe

Bhils practiced theft and dacoity as traditional occupation. Their mythology explains this: they believe **Goddess Parvati was a Bhil**. When the Bhils demanded bride price from Lord Shiva, he refused. In anger, they killed **Nandi** (Shiva's sacred bull). They were **cursed to live in poverty** but were given a **Vardaan (boon): theft for livelihood invites no sin**. Some Bhil sub-tribes still consider themselves "**thieves of Mahadev**" — a fascinating example of how Hindu mythology was reinterpreted through tribal lens to legitimize traditional occupations.

Positive Impacts of Hinduism

Impact	Details and Examples
1. Cultural Integration and Social Mobility	Through Sanskritisation (Srinivas, 1952), tribes like Gonds, Bhils, and Oraons adopted Hindu customs (vegetarianism, Brahmin priests, sacred thread) to claim higher social status. This provided a ladder of upward mobility within the caste-based social hierarchy.
2. Incorporation into Civilizational Ethos	Tribal deities were absorbed into the Hindu pantheon — Gond deity Pharsa Pen became identified with Shiva ; Santhal Marang Buru became Mahadeo . This gave tribal religions a broader civilizational identity and prevented total cultural erasure.
3. Spread of Agriculture and Settled Life	Peasantization (N.K. Bose) — tribes like Bhumij, Bhils, and Oraons moved from shifting cultivation (jhum) to settled agriculture. This brought economic stability, surplus production, and integration into regional markets.
4. Introduction of Literacy and Political Authority	Raj Gonds used Sanskrit titles (Raja, Thakur) to legitimize political authority. Adoption of Hindu literary traditions introduced literacy among certain tribal elites.
5. Religious Tolerance and Coexistence	Hinduism's polytheistic worldview allowed coexistence. Navakhani (harvest festival of Oraons) and Holi (Bhils) were celebrated jointly by tribals and non-tribals, fostering social harmony.

Negative Impacts of Hinduism

Impact	Details and Examples
1. Replacement of Simple Rituals	Lambadi (Banjara) tribes now employ Brahmin priests for life-cycle rituals (birth, marriage, death) — creating economic dependence on non-tribal ritual specialists. Simple, egalitarian tribal ceremonies were replaced by elaborate, expensive Hindu rituals.
2. Decline of Traditional Institutions	Youth dormitories like Ghotul (Muria Gonds) and Dhumkuria (Oraons) declined under Hindu moral codes. These institutions served vital functions — socialization, sex education, leadership training, cultural transmission — all lost when Hindu notions of sexual morality were imposed.

3. Emergence of Dowry	Egalitarian bride price system (which valued women) was replaced by dowry among Ho, Munda, and Gond tribes — reversing gender norms and introducing economic burden on girls' families.
4. Child Marriage and Widow Restrictions	Bhil and Gond tribes adopted child marriage practices; widow remarriage — perfectly normal in tribal societies — was now prohibited under Hindu influence.
5. Caste-like Hierarchies	Raj Gonds developed internal stratification resembling caste — with priests, warriors, and commoner sub-groups. Similar hierarchies emerged among Oraons and Bhils. The egalitarian tribal ethos was undermined.
6. Loss of Cultural Autonomy	Tribal deities were subordinated as local manifestations of Hindu gods. Tribal origin myths were reinterpreted through the Hindu cosmological lens — erasing distinctly tribal worldviews.

⇒ **V.R. Elwin** — documented the decline of traditional institutions like Ghotul and Dhumkuria under Hindu moral codes.

Conclusion: Hinduism has had a significant influence on tribal societies, leading to the development of the **Tribe-Caste Continuum**. Interaction resulted in assimilation of novel customs and practices — both enriching and eroding tribal identity.

2. IMPACT OF CHRISTIANITY ON TRIBAL SOCIETIES (8.1)

Overview

- Spread of Christianity began during the **colonial period** through European missionaries.
- Christianity is the **second largest religion among tribal communities**, next only to Hinduism.
- The **Northeastern region** has the highest concentration of Christian tribal populations — Nagaland (~90%), Mizoram (~87%), Meghalaya (~75%).

Positive Impacts of Christianity

1. Christianity as Early Agency of Tribal Welfare

⇒ **K.N. Sahay** — described missionaries as the **earliest welfare workers** among tribals, arriving in remote areas long before any government scheme.

Missionaries were the **first organized agency for tribal welfare** before state schemes existed. They brought literacy, healthcare, and social awareness to remote forest areas that the colonial and post-colonial state neglected.

2. Introduction of Education and Tribal Scripts

Region	Missionary Contribution
Mizoram	Rev. J.H. Lorrain and F.W. Savidge (1894) — established schools, translated books into Mizo language, created a written Mizo script
Nagaland	American Baptist Mission — first village school at Molungyimsen (1872). Women became teachers — a revolutionary gender shift in Naga society.
Jharkhand/Chhattisgarh	Rev. John Baptist Hoffmann (Munda grammar), Paul Olaf Boddington (Santal dictionary) — documented and preserved tribal languages in written form
Arunachal Pradesh	Among Adi and Nyishi tribes, mission schools were the first and only sources of literacy

3. Westernization of Tribals

Christianity introduced Western lifestyle elements — shirts, trousers, church attendance, Western music, English language. In **Nagaland**, traditional practices like **headhunting** and **fertility rituals** disappeared entirely. In **Arunachal Pradesh**, festivals like **Nyokum** (Nyishi) and **Mopin** (Adi) were transformed from religious rituals into cultural events — retaining the celebration but removing the spiritual core.

4. Elimination of Harmful Practices

In certain tribes, if a **mother died during childbirth, the baby was buried with her** (belief that the child belonged to the dead mother's spirit). Missionaries established **orphanages and infant homes**, saving countless newborn lives.

5. Improved Health and Hygiene

Missionaries established dispensaries, hospitals, health camps, vaccination drives, and maternal care centres. **Mission hospitals in Arunachal Pradesh and Jharkhand** became the only reliable medical

centres in remote tribal areas for decades.

6. Prohibition of Alcohol

The **Young Mizo Association (YMA)** campaigned against rice beer (**Zu**). This significantly reduced alcoholism and family disputes in Mizoram — a genuine improvement in quality of life.

7. Syncretism and Religious Coexistence

In **Jharkhand**, Christian Santals and Oraons celebrate **Karma** and **Sohrai** festivals with drums and hymns — blending tribal and Christian traditions.

⇒ **Verrier Elwin** described this as "**religious layering**" — new beliefs are added on top of existing ones without erasing them. A form of syncretism where tribal identity and Christian faith coexist.

Negative Impacts of Christianity

1. Ethnocentric Approach

Missionaries viewed tribal faiths as "primitive" and "heathen" — leading to deliberate erosion of customs, songs, dances, and social institutions. This ethnocentric approach failed to respect the cultural validity of tribal belief systems.

2. Sense of Superiority among Converts

⇒ **K.N. Sahay** observed that **Christian Oraons** of Chotanagpur developed a feeling of **superiority over non-Christian Oraons** — fracturing tribal unity and creating internal divisions within the same community.

3. Demographic Change

Region	Conversion Scale
Arunachal Pradesh	Conversion among Wancho, Nocte, Tangsa, Nyishi rose from less than 5% (1970s) to ~80% (2011)
Nagaland	~90% of Nagas (Ao, Angami, Lotha, Sema) became Christian via Miles Bronson and E.W. Clark's missions
Mizoram	Mizo population converted almost entirely by early 20th century

4. Loss of Traditional Institutions

The **Morung** (Nagas) and **Ghotul** (Gonds) — youth dormitories that served as centres for cultural transmission, folklore, moral instruction, and socialization — declined sharply. Mundas and Oraons stopped celebrating **Karma** and **Sarhul** festivals.

5. Gender Impact — Complex and Contradictory

In **Nagaland**, Christianity empowered women as **teachers** — a new social role. However, among **Adi and Nyishi** tribes in Arunachal Pradesh, Christianity **displaced female shamans** who held positions of spiritual authority. The net gender impact was thus mixed — empowering in some contexts, disempowering in others.

6. Neglect of Socio-economic Interests

Among the **Khasis** of Meghalaya, Christianity created **vertical divisions** within society — between Christians and non-Christians from the same tribe — rather than addressing the material problems of poverty, land alienation, and exploitation that all Khasis faced.

⇒ **Tanka Bahadur Subba** — argued that conversions were often motivated by **education and welfare benefits** offered by missions, not by genuine spiritual conviction.

7. Resistance and Revivalist Movements

Movement	Details
Donyi-Polo Movement (Arunachal Pradesh)	Institutionalized Sun-Moon worship through temples (Khumkos) and schools. Youth groups actively promoted indigenous faith as counter to Christianity.
Sarna Dharma Revival (Central India)	Reaffirmed nature worship (Singbonga) among Munda and Oraon. All India Sarna Samiti demands separate Census code for Sarna religion.
Gond Mahasabha	Promotes Koya Punem , worshipping Baradeo as supreme god — asserting a distinct Gond religious identity.

8. Political Identity Implications

- **IFCSAP (Arunachal Pradesh):** Demands delisting of converted Christians from ST benefits
- **Nagaland/Mizoram:** Christianity became the base for ethnic nationalism
- **Jaipal Singh Munda:** Blended Christian and tribal ideals to mobilize Adivasi political movements

Cultural Revival in Context

⇒ **Nirmal Minz** — observed that **Christian Oraons still honored ancestral spirits** alongside Christian faith — showing that conversion was not total replacement but layered identity.

⇒ **Andre Beteille** — argued that conversion leads to **reformulation of identity**, not erasure — converts create a new hybrid identity that is neither fully tribal nor fully Christian.

Cultural revival examples: **Donyi-Polo youth groups** in Arunachal; **Nagaland church choirs** singing in tribal languages; **Jharkhand** communities practicing both **Sarna and Christian** traditions simultaneously.

Conclusion: Christianity played a **transformative yet complex** role — bringing education, literacy, healthcare, and social reforms, yet also causing cultural loss and religious polarization.

3. IMPACT OF BUDDHISM ON TRIBAL SOCIETIES (8.1)

Overview

- Buddhism is followed by around **0.5%** of India's tribal population — limited but significant impact.
- Spread linked to **Mauryan and Kushan emperors**; Emperor **Ashoka** played a key role through edicts and missionaries.
- Buddhism is described as a **"way of life"** rather than a rigid religion — tribes could follow it alongside their own beliefs without being asked to abandon them.
- Impact primarily concentrated in **North-west and North-east Himalayan regions**.

Key Tribal Groups Influenced by Buddhism

Tribe	Region	Buddhist Tradition
Bhutia	Sikkim, Darjeeling	Vajrayana Buddhism (17th-18th century)
Lepcha	Sikkim, NE Himalayas, Bhutan	Syncretism with Bon-like healing rituals
Chakma	Mizoram, Arunachal Pradesh	Theravada Buddhism
Monpa, Sherdukpen, Khowa	Arunachal Pradesh	Mahayana Buddhism
Brokpa, Changpa, Balti	Ladakh	Mahayana Buddhism

Establishment of Gompas (Monasteries)

Monasteries like **Bapuchang** were established in Khampti and Singpho villages. Sacred specialists are called **Lamas**. Gompas became centres of learning, healing, and community gathering — integrating into existing tribal social structures rather than replacing them.

Symbiosis of Buddhism and Tribal Rituals

⇒ **C. von Furer-Haimendorf (1983)**: Buddhist converts in Arunachal Pradesh **did not renounce tribal rituals** — they maintained a symbiotic relationship where Buddhist and tribal practices coexisted without conflict.

Unlike Christianity (which often demanded exclusive allegiance), Buddhism allowed for **dual practice**. This is because Buddhism's non-dogmatic nature, emphasis on ethics over exclusivity, and acceptance of local gods as Dharma protectors facilitated a **syncretic evolution** rather than replacement.

Detailed Case Studies

1. Bhutia (Sikkim, Darjeeling): Follow Vajrayana Buddhism since 17th-18th century. **Losoon** (Sikkimese New Year) is celebrated alongside animistic dances — demonstrating **cultural continuity within conversion**. Buddhist identity did not erase pre-Buddhist festive traditions.

2. Lepcha (Sikkim, NE Himalayas): Original inhabitants of Sikkim. Maintain **Bon-like healing rituals** and ancestor worship alongside Buddhist ceremonies — a clear case of **syncretism**. The Lepcha Boengthing

(shaman) coexists with Buddhist Lamas.

3. Chakma (Arunachal, Mizoram): Theravada Buddhists who still worship **Lakshmi and forest spirits**. Their village councils blend Buddhist moral codes with customary law — demonstrating **accommodation, not replacement**.

4. Monpa/Sherdukpen/Khowa (Arunachal Pradesh): Follow Mahayana Buddhism. **Sherdukpen worship tribal deities alongside Lamas of Gompas**. Among Monpas, elements of the ancient **Bon religion** coexist with dominant Buddhist faith — a **symbiotic** relationship.

5. Brokpa/Changpa/Balti (Ladakh): Mahayana Buddhism is dominant, but pre-Buddhist mountain-spirit worship (**Lha/Yul-lha**) and animal-sacrifice rituals continue — showing **religious coexistence** across millennia.

Conclusion: Buddhism integrated with indigenous cosmologies **rather than replacing them**. Even the adoption of Buddhism could not cut through traditional beliefs. The result was **syncretic evolution** — a limited but significant impact that preserved tribal cultural identity.

4. IMPACT OF ISLAM ON TRIBAL SOCIETIES (8.1)

Overview

- Islam's penetration into tribal societies faced challenges due to its **dogmatic nature** — its strict monotheism and codified laws made accommodation with tribal polytheism difficult.
- Limited support from Muslim rulers for systematic conversion of tribals.
- Dissemination fell largely upon **Sufi saints and preachers** who used a more flexible, mystical approach.

Muslim Tribal Groups

Group	Region	Islamic Identity + Tribal Retention
Bakarwal and Gujjar Bakarwal	J and K, Ladakh	Nomadic pastoralists, Sunni Muslim, ST since 1991. Transhumance (seasonal migration with herds) intact. Gujari language retained. Marriage and seasonal movement follow traditional pastoral rules, not Islamic urban norms.
Siddi	Gujarat, Karnataka, Goa	African origin (brought as slaves/soldiers). Muslim but retain African music/dance traditions (Goma/Dhamaal). Islam is overlaid on older African cultural base — dual heritage.
Lakshadweep Islanders	Lakshadweep	Sunni Muslim but still matrilineal, still have Taravad, still practise duolocal residence. 7 Muslim tribal communities: Koya, Malmi, Malacheri, Manikfan, Thakrufan, Thakru, Reveri.
Van Gujjars	NW Himalayas	Pastoral, Sunni Muslim. Marriage and seasonal movement follow traditional pastoral rules rather than mainstream Islamic practice.
Bhils, Kotis, Dhankasi	Rajasthan	Partial Islamic influence in western Rajasthan.

General Impacts of Islam on Tribal Societies

Impact	Details
Shift to Patrilineal Norms	Islamic personal law mandates patrilineal inheritance. Tribes with matrilineal/bilateral systems faced pressure to transition.
Islamisation of Life Cycle Rituals	Progressive replacement of tribal birth, marriage, death rituals with Islamic procedures (naming ceremonies, nikah, burial rites).
Observance of Islamic Festivals	Prophet Mohammed's birthday (Milad-un-Nabi), Ramadan, Eid adopted — sometimes replacing indigenous harvest or seasonal festivals.
Decline of Indigenous Practices	Folk dances, indigenous music, spirit-worship rituals declined sharply in Islamised tribal communities.
Replacement of Tribal Social Order	Islamic personal laws (Sharia-based inheritance, divorce, marriage rules) replaced traditional social mechanisms and customary law.
Preference for Cousin Marriages	Cross-cousin marriages became preferential among converted tribes — a practice alien to most tribal kinship systems.

Islam and Matriliney — Lakshadweep (Detailed Case Study)

⇒ **K.S. Singh** — Islam came to the Arabian Sea islands from **Southern Arabia**, not directly from the Indian mainland.

The Taravad (Matrilineal Unit)

The **Taravad** is a group of individuals tracing descent through common genealogy from an **ancestress** in an unbroken female line. Key features:

- **Depth:** 3 to 6 or more generations
- Every Taravad has a **name** used as prefix to personal names — identity marker
- Birth in a Taravad gives the right to share in **Taravad property** (land, trees, boats, buildings) — all property passes through **female members**
- Male members have only **usufructuary rights** (right to use, not to own/inherit)
- Taravad is a **matrilineal exogamous unit** — members must marry outside their Taravad
- The father has **no legal responsibility** for children's maintenance — children belong to the **mother's descent group**
- A man can give away his **individual (self-earned) property** to his children, but Taravad property follows female line

Islam's Influence on Matriliney

- Islamic marriage procedure was adopted BUT the **duolocal residence pattern was not given up**

⇒ **Hanson** — identified the **duolocal residence pattern** in Lakshadweep: men and women (including spouses) live in **separate houses**. The husband visits the wife's Taravad house but does not live there permanently.

- Most religious activities (festivals, Quran chanting, fulfillment of vows) are carried out **within the context of the matrilineal group**, not the conjugal family
- If a Taravad has an **ancestor-saint**, the anniversary is celebrated by the **entire matrilineage**
- Islam provides **easy divorce** (talaq) — this led to **high frequency of divorce** in Lakshadweep, since matrilineal economic security meant women were not dependent on husbands
- **Marriage system instability:** Easy divorce combined with matrilineal support created a pattern of serial marriages

Current Changes (Islamisation)

Matrilineal practices (inheritance through mother, duolocal residence) are **gradually eroding**. Growing shift toward **patriliney, nuclear family residence, and male headship** under pressure of Islamic reform movements and modernization. Background: Lakshadweep matriliney was brought by the nearest coastal people of **Kerala** (similar to Nair matriliney).

⇒ **Leela Dube and Kutty (1969)** — documented the matrilineal concept in Lakshadweep in detail.

⇒ **Aiyappan** — argued that Lakshadweep islanders are **not tribals** in the conventional sense — they are **indistinguishable from Moplahs (Mappilas) of Kerala** in culture, language, and social organization.

Negative Impacts of Islam

1. **Erosion of Traditional Kinship:** Shift from matrilineal/bilateral systems to patrilineal under Sharia inheritance rules — Lakshadweep Taravad weakened significantly.
2. **Decline of Indigenous Rituals:** Ancestor worship, spirit appeasement, sacred dances replaced by namaz, fasting, and Islamic festivals.
3. **Dual Marginalisation:** Gujjars and Bakarwals perceived as socially inferior to **Ashraf Muslims** (Syeds, Pathans) — excluded from both Islamic upper-caste hierarchy and mainstream economy.

Conclusion: Islam influenced tribal societies through new religious practices, laws, and social norms. Yet tribes like those in Lakshadweep **adapted Islam within their own cultural frameworks**, creating a unique blend of faith and indigenous identity.

5. TRIBE AND NATION STATE (8.2)

Key Definitions

- ⇒ **D.N. Majumdar** defined **Tribe**: "A social group with territorial affiliation, endogamous, with no specialization of functions, ruled by tribal officers — hereditary or otherwise — united in language or dialect, recognizing social distance with other tribes and castes."
- ⇒ **Lucy Mair** defined tribe as an "**independent political division**" of a population with a common culture.
- ⇒ **Eller** defined **Nation**: A community based on shared language, history, ethnicity, culture, and society — the collective identity of a group.
- ⇒ **Max Weber** defined **State**: A centralized political organization that maintains a "**monopoly on the legitimate use of violence**" over a population within a territory.

Concept	Definition	Example
Tribe	Social group with territorial affiliation, endogamous, no specialization, ruled by hereditary/other officers, united in language	Nagas, Bhils, Gonds
Nation	Community based on shared language, history, ethnicity, culture — collective identity	Kurds (nation without state)
State	Centralized political organization with monopoly on legitimate violence (Weber)	Any sovereign government
Nation State	Where state and nation are congruent — people share common identity	France, Germany, Japan

Key distinctions: **Kurds** = nation without a state; **France, Germany, Japan** = nation-states; **Korea** = one nation divided into two states (North and South).

Who are Indigenous and Tribal Peoples?

- More than **370 million people** in more than **70 countries** worldwide
- No universal definition exists; **ILO Convention No. 169** takes a practical approach
- Other terms used globally: native peoples, aboriginal peoples, first nations, adivasi, janajati, hunter-gatherers, hill tribes
- In **Latin America**: "tribal" is applied to some afro-descendent communities

ILO Convention No. 169 — Criteria

Category	Subjective Criteria	Objective Criteria
Indigenous peoples	Self-identification as indigenous	Descent from populations present at time of conquest/colonization; retain own social, economic, cultural, political institutions
Tribal peoples	Self-identification as tribal	Social, cultural, economic conditions distinguish them from national community; status regulated by customs, traditions, or special laws

India's Special Case: The division into **indigenous vs. settlers** is **NOT valid** in India. Unlike the Americas or Australia where European colonizers displaced native populations, India cannot be divided into natives and

non-natives — all communities have inhabited the subcontinent for millennia. Hence India prefers the term "Scheduled Tribes" rather than "indigenous peoples."

Challenges of Tribes vis-a-vis Nation States

1. **Tribal identity and culture:** Distinct cultures, languages, traditions lead to conflicts over land rights and cultural preservation when the state imposes uniform laws.
2. **Self-governance and self-determination:** Tribal desire for autonomy clashes with centralized state authority. Self-determination is recognized as a fundamental human right.
3. **Colonization and forced assimilation:** History of colonization created deep resentment and mistrust. The nation-state must acknowledge historical injustices before meaningful reconciliation.

Comparative Case Studies

Native American Governance (5 Types)

Type	Example	Details
Self-Government	Navajo Nation	Own constitution, elected president, legislative council. Largest reservation in the US (71,000 sq km). Manages own schools, police, courts.
Traditional Governance	Haudenosaunee (Iroquois Confederacy)	Maintain traditional council of chiefs; clan mothers select leaders. One of world's oldest participatory democracies.
Modern Constitutional	Cherokee Nation	Adopted modern democratic constitution with three branches of government, modelled on US system.
Voter Participation	Various tribes	Participate in federal/state elections while maintaining separate tribal governance.
Government-to-Government	Bureau of Indian Affairs (BIA)	Federal relationship treats tribes as sovereign entities with government-to-government negotiations.

Native American Reservations

Navajo Nation — largest reservation, ~71,000 sq km. **Standing Rock Sioux** — site of famous 2016 pipeline protests. **Indian Removal Act (1830)** — forced relocation of southeastern tribes to Oklahoma ("Trail of Tears").

⇒ **Robert J. Miller** — documented widespread poverty, malnutrition, and low living standards on Native American reservations. The isolation approach led to economic marginalization.

Australian Stolen Generations

1910-1970: Approximately **100,000 Indigenous children** were forcibly removed from their families and placed with white families or in institutions — the assimilationist approach at its most extreme.

Aboriginal Protection Act of 1869 (Victoria): Restricted movement and autonomy of Indigenous Australians.

Policies were abolished in the 1970s-80s, but the intergenerational trauma continues to affect Aboriginal communities today. In 2008, PM Kevin Rudd issued a formal national apology.

6. APPROACHES TO TRIBAL DEVELOPMENT

1. Isolationist Approach — "Keep Them Apart"

Proponent: Verrier Elwin in 'The Baiga', 1939

Core idea: Tribes should be left alone with minimum outside contact. They should be protected from exploitation by outsiders.

National Park Theory: Elwin proposed giving tribes a huge tract of land to live in isolation — like a "national park" for human communities.

Image metaphor: Two separate bowls — tribal society and mainstream society kept apart.

Criticism of Isolationism:

- Accused of being **"romantic and impractical"** — isolation cannot be maintained in modern world
- Critics said Elwin wanted to keep tribes as **"anthropological museums"** or "labs" for field studies
- Suspected of deliberately keeping tribes underdeveloped
- Tribes should contribute to and benefit from national development

⇒ **Thakkar Bapa** — strongly criticized isolationism. He promoted assimilation and worked with Ghurye to bring tribes into Hindu mainstream.

Example — USA Indian Reservation System: Reservations created to isolate Native Americans. Life was extremely difficult — poverty, malnutrition, low living standards. In 1868, President Ulysses S. Grant tried to solve this through assimilation via Christian clergy, but this led to violent resistance and was abandoned. The failure of both isolation AND forced assimilation in the US case demonstrates the need for a middle path.

2. Assimilationist Approach — "Melting Pot"

Proponents: G.S. Ghurye and Thakkar Bapa (A.V. Thakkar)

Core idea: Tribes should be absorbed into the mainstream. They would lose their customs, language, and traditions but gain access to mainstream development.

Ghurye called tribals **"backward Hindus"** — arguing they were simply undeveloped Hindus who would catch up by mingling with the rest of Hindu society.

Image metaphor: Melting pot — all ingredients dissolved into one homogeneous mixture.

Criticism of Assimilationism:

- **Ethnocentric:** Assumes mainstream culture is superior — fails to respect tribal cultural autonomy
- **Culturally dominant:** Imposes dominant group's values, language, religion on minorities
- **Top-down:** Gives tribes no agency or choice in the process
- **Loss of autonomy:** Tribal identity, languages, art forms permanently destroyed
- Forced assimilation is inherently unfair and violates human rights

Example — Australia's "Stolen Generations" (1910-1970): ~100,000 Indigenous children removed from families, placed with white families. Aboriginal Protection Act of 1869 restricted movement. Policies abolished in 1970s-80s; impacts still felt — intergenerational trauma, loss of language, severed family bonds.

3. Integrationist Approach — "Salad Bowl" (India's Chosen Approach)

Proponent: Post-independent Verrier Elwin in 'A Philosophy for NEFA', 1957 (foreword by Jawaharlal Nehru)

⇒ Elwin evolved from isolationist (1939) to integrationist (1957) — a significant intellectual shift.

Core idea: Integrating tribes into mainstream while they **retain their identity**. How, when, and to what extent to integrate — **choice left to tribals themselves**.

Adopted officially by **Nehru** as India's tribal policy.

Image metaphor: Salad bowl — each ingredient keeps its distinct flavor while contributing to the whole.

Tribal Panchsheel — 5 Principles (Nehru, 1957)

#	Principle	Explanation
1	Non-imposition	Tribals should develop along the lines of their own genius. Nothing should be imposed on them from outside. Respect their worldview.
2	Respect for tribal rights	Rights to land and forests must be respected. These are not just economic resources but integral to tribal identity and spirituality.
3	Development of tribal leadership	Train tribal youth to lead their own administration. Outsiders should not govern tribal areas — self-governance is key.
4	Simplicity of administration	Avoid over-bureaucratisation. Schemes should be people-centric, not target-centric. Keep governance simple and accessible.
5	Emphasis on human growth	Evaluate success by quality of life improvements, not by statistics or expenditure figures. Human development over economic metrics.

UNDRIP 2007 (United Nations Declaration on Rights of Indigenous People)

⇒ **UNDRIP** — United Nations Declaration on Rights of Indigenous People (2007)

- **Article 8 (Against forced assimilation):** Indigenous peoples have the right **not to be subjected to forced assimilation or destruction of their culture**. States shall provide effective mechanisms for prevention and redress.

- **Article 5 (For integration):** Indigenous peoples have the right to **maintain and strengthen their distinct political, legal, economic, social, and cultural institutions** while retaining the right to **participate fully in the political, economic, social, and cultural life of the State**.

Affirmative Action — USA (Comparative Perspective)

Affirmative action policies in the USA address historical discrimination against African Americans, Hispanic Americans, Native Americans, and women through preferential treatment in education and employment.

Fisher v. University of Texas (2016): The US Supreme Court upheld the use of **race as a factor in admissions** but applied a stricter standard — requiring the university to demonstrate that **no workable race-neutral alternative** existed. This case is central to the **reverse discrimination debate** — critics argue affirmative action discriminates against non-minority applicants.

7. HISTORY OF TRIBAL ADMINISTRATION IN INDIA (9.1)

British Era — Isolationist and Exploitative

Rationale behind British Isolationist Policy (4 Reasons)

#	Reason	Details
1	Security and Political Control	Tribal groups seen as "explosive" — e.g., Santhal Uprising. Isolation cut them off from national independence movements.
2	Economic Interests	Tribal belts rich in forests and minerals. Forest laws were designed to secure timber and land for British revenue and railways.
3	Cultural Justification	British anthropologists portrayed tribes as "noble savages" who needed protection from mainstream society — a paternalistic justification.
4	Missionary Access	Allowed missionaries and select officials entry — achieving cultural penetration alongside political dominance.

Case Study: The Malers (Paharias) of Rajmahal Hills

Among the first tribes placed under a separate administrative model. **Cleveland** established a **ring-fence of sepoys** around the hill tracts to isolate Paharias from the plains. In **1782**, the Rajmahal Hill Tract was withdrawn from the ordinary judicial system. A **special Hill Assembly** was created with tribal representatives and British officers — which could even impose **capital punishment**.

This was codified as **Regulation I of 1796**, later repealed by **Regulation I of 1827**. The area was known as **Daman-e-Koh** — governed through indirect rule with limited tribal autonomy. This became the **prototype for later "special administrative areas"** across India.

Tribal Uprisings (5 Major)

Uprising	Year	Details
Ho Mutiny of Singhbhum	1831	Against British taxation and land alienation
Khond Uprising	1846	Against suppression of Meriah sacrifice and loss of autonomy
Santhal Rebellion	1855-56	Largest tribal uprising; against zamindars, moneylenders, and British; led by Sidhu and Kanhu
Angami Naga Resistance	1879-80	Against British expansion into Naga Hills
Abor and Lushai Expeditions	1880-1910	British military campaigns in northeastern frontier tribal areas

Causes of uprisings: Loss of land/forest rights (Permanent Settlement, Forest Acts), economic exploitation by zamindars and moneylenders, cultural displacement, political marginalization.

Major British Legislative Measures

Law	Key Provisions
Scheduled District Act 1874 (Act XIV)	Exempted specified districts from conventional laws; aimed to protect tribes from exploitation by outsiders.

Government of India Act 1919	Two types of tribal areas created: Wholly excluded areas : Completely outside British legislation; Governor has sole legislative authority. Partially excluded areas : Partially exempted from legislation.
Government of India Act 1935	Based on Simon Commission recommendations; continued designation as excluded and partially excluded zones.

Post-Independence Tribal Administration

Constitutional Provisions

Provision	Details
Article 342	Defines Scheduled Tribes; President can declare tribes as STs by notification.
Article 366(25)	ST means tribes or tribal communities deemed under Article 342.
DPSP	State shall promote with special care the educational and economic interests of STs and protect them from social injustice.
Article 244 (Part IV)	President can declare any area with substantial tribal population as Scheduled Area (Fifth Schedule).
Fifth Schedule	Administration of tribal areas in states other than NE — Tribes Advisory Council, Governor's powers.
Sixth Schedule	Administration of northeastern tribal areas — Autonomous District Councils with legislative, judicial, executive powers.
Fifth Five-Year Plan	Introduced Tribal Sub-Plan (TSP) for integrated tribal development.

⇒ **Prof. S.C. Dube** chaired the **TSP Expert Committee (1972)** under Ministry of Education and Social Welfare that recommended the Tribal Sub-Plan approach.

British Era vs. Post-Independence — Comparison

Dimension	British Era	Post-Independence
Approach	Isolation and control	Integrationist and empowerment
Objective	Maintain colonial order, extract resources	Social justice, inclusion, national integration
Laws	Criminal Tribes Act 1871, Scheduled District Act 1874, GoI Act 1935	Constitutional safeguards, PESA 1996, FRA 2006
Administration	Centralised, autocratic, exploitative	Decentralised, participatory (Panchayati Raj)
Outcome	Widespread alienation, land dispossession, uprisings	Uneven progress; persistent challenges in displacement, inequality

Comparative Perspective Conclusion: The trajectory of tribal administration globally has been from **subjugation to self-determination** — from colonial exploitation through paternalistic protection to participatory governance and rights-based approaches.

8. PARTICULARLY VULNERABLE TRIBAL GROUPS — PVTGs (9.1)

General Tribal Features vs. PVTG Features

General tribal features: Primitive traits, distinctive culture, geographical isolation, shyness of contact, backwardness.

Additional PVTG features (over and above general tribal features):

- Dependency on **hunting and gathering** for food
- **Pre-agriculture level of technology**
- **Zero or negative growth of population**
- Extremely **low level of literacy**

Need for Identification of PVTGs (5 Reasons)

1. Within STs, some groups were **far more vulnerable** and were not benefiting from general tribal welfare schemes.
2. Their **pre-agricultural technology** meant they could not participate in development programs designed for agrarian tribes.
3. **Declining populations** threatened their very survival as communities.
4. Geographic isolation meant mainstream development did not reach them.
5. Cases like **Narikkuravar** (nomadic tribe in Tamil Nadu) showed that certain communities fell through all classification cracks and needed special attention.

Historical Development

⇒ **Dhebar Commission (1973)** — created the category of **Primitive Tribal Groups (PTGs)** as a sub-category within Scheduled Tribes.

- **1975:** Government of India identified **52 groups** as PVTGs
- **1993:** Another **23 groups** added — total **75 PVTGs** out of **705 Scheduled Tribes**
- Spread across **18 States and 1 Union Territory** (2011 Census)
- **2006:** Government renamed PTGs as **PVTGs (Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups)** — to remove the pejorative connotation of "primitive"
- **AnSI (Anthropological Survey of India) 2017 publication** — documented detailed profiles of all 75 PVTGs

⇒ **Xaxa Committee** — recommended improved criteria for PVTG identification, including more granular socio-economic indicators.

PVTG Population Details

- 2001 Census: approximately **27,68,322**

- **12 PVTGs** have population over 50,000; remaining have 1,000 or less
- **Huge variation:** From **Great Andamanese, Onge, Sentinelese** (very few individuals — under 100) to **Toda of Nilgiris** (~1,000+)
- **Declining PVTGs:** Onge, Andamanese — biggest reason: **inbreeding** due to extremely small population
- **Stagnant:** Birhor in central India
- **Largest PVTG: Saharia people of Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan** — population more than 4 lakhs

| Literacy and Education

Literacy increased from **single digit to 30-40%** in many PVTGs. However, **female literacy** remains considerably lower than male.

Factors for low literacy: Linguistic barriers (curriculum in unfamiliar language), social exclusion, lack of cultural sensitivity in schools, discrimination by non-tribal teachers and students, poor infrastructure (no schools within walking distance).

| Livelihood and Forest Rights

PVTGs depend on: **food gathering, Non-Timber Forest Produce (NTFP), hunting, livestock rearing, shifting cultivation, artisan works**. Forests are their life and livelihood — not just economic but spiritual and cultural resources.

Forest Rights Act 2006 — Provisions for PVTGs

- **Section 3(1)(e) FRA:** Recognizes "**rights including community tenures of habitat and habitation for primitive tribal groups and pre-agricultural communities**"
- **Section 2(h) FRA:** Defines 'habitat' as **customary habitat in Reserved and Protected Forests of PTGs and pre-agricultural communities**

Challenges to Livelihood

Baiga families (2009): Moved out of **Achanakmar Reserve** — lost traditional forest livelihood with no proper compensation or alternative.

Kattunayakans (Tamil Nadu): Prevented from collecting honey in **Mudumalai Wildlife Sanctuary** — faced harassment from forest guards despite FRA rights.

PVTGs face exploitation by **middlemen** who purchase NTFP (honey, tendu leaves, medicinal herbs) at fraction of market value because PVTGs are unaware of true value.

| Health Issues

Key health challenges: poverty, lack of safe drinking water, bad sanitary conditions, difficult terrain (preventing ambulance access), chronic malnutrition, poor maternal health. Common diseases: **Anaemia, Malaria, Gastro-intestinal disorders**.

⇒ **Dr. Abhay Bang** — headed the Expert Committee on Tribal Health. Report: "**Tribal Health in India — Bridging the Gap and a Roadmap for the Future**" (first of its kind).

Bonded Labour

⇒ **Sahariya (Rajasthan)** — work as bonded labour for rich landlords for generations. Tricked into loans with exorbitant interest rates through the **Hali system**. Debt is inherited across generations.

⇒ **Anumena Yadav** — documented the **goti system** among **Juangs (PVTGs in Odisha)** — a form of debt bondage.

Bonded labour banned under **Bonded Labour (Abolition) Act 1976**. In Odisha, the **Orissa Debt Bondage (Abolition and Regulation) Act, 1948** was enacted even earlier — but enforcement remains weak.

Schemes for PVTGs

- Ministry of Tribal Affairs implements "**Development of Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs)**"
- **Conservation-Cum-Development (CCD)**: Annual plans prepared by each state/UT based on need assessment, approved by Project Appraisal Committee

9. DENOTIFIED TRIBES — DNTs (7.1)

Historical Background — Criminal Tribes Acts

The history of DNTs traces to the **Criminal Tribes Acts (CTA) of 1871** (later amended in 1911). Under this colonial law, **150-200 communities** were deemed "**Hereditary Criminals**" — subjected to surveillance, confinement, and gross discrimination.

Legal Definition from CTA: "A Criminal Tribe is a gang, tribe or class of people addicted to the systematic commission of Non-Bailable Offenses and with reason to believe, a local Government could notify using the local gazette that an entire tribe, gang or class of people were criminals."

Key features of CTA:

- Part of colonial model — communities that **resisted British rule** were targeted
- **Criteria:** Only "reason to believe" needed (not factual evidence) that a community was "addicted" to crime
- Based on the notion that **crime was a genetic trait** passed down through generations — deeply unscientific

⇒ **Dilip D'Souza** — observed that the colonial law **criminalized entire communities** rather than individual offenders, creating a permanent stigma that outlived the law itself.

Repeal and Its Aftermath

- CTA repealed in **1952** on recommendation of **All India Criminal Tribes Inquiry Committee (1949)**

⇒ **Shri Ananthasayanam Ayyangar Committee** — recommended the repeal of CTA.

- 'Criminal Tribes' became '**Denotified Tribes**'
- CTA replaced by **Habitual Offenders Act, 1951** — which critics say perpetuates the same stigma under a new name
- Communities celebrate **August 31 as their Independence Day** (denotification date), but stigma remains deeply embedded in police practice and public perception

⇒ **A.P. Jithender Reddy** — argued that **repeal alone will not fix DNT issues** — comprehensive rehabilitation, de-stigmatisation, and positive discrimination are needed.

Classification Anomalies

⇒ **Banjaras** — classic example of classification anomaly:

State	Classification
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Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Bihar	Scheduled Tribe
Karnataka, Delhi, Rajasthan	Scheduled Caste
Uttar Pradesh	OBC
Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu	Denotified Tribe

This inconsistency means the same community receives different benefits (or none) depending on which state they live in.

6 Challenges Faced by DNTs

#	Challenge	Details
1	Social Stigma	Labelled "born criminals" — stigma not abolished even after 1952 repeal. Police still profile these communities.
2	Economic Hardship	Traditional occupations (snake charming, street acrobatics, performing with animals) notified as criminal activities. Left without alternative livelihoods.
3	Large-scale Exclusions	Spread among SC/ST/OBC categories but many not classified anywhere. Severe lack of data — even basic census data missing.
4	Poor Grievance Redressal	No permanent commission (unlike NCSC for SCs or NCST for STs) to hear complaints and advocate for DNT rights.
5	Lack of Uniform Approach	Anomalies in identification from state to state (as shown by Banjara example).
6	Declining Population	Result of accumulated disadvantages — poverty, stigma, lack of healthcare, social exclusion.

Recommendations

- **Repeal of Habitual Offenders Act, 1952** (which perpetuates CTA stigma)
- Repeal must be accompanied by slew of **legal reforms**
- **Socio-economic survey** through reputed social science institutes (basic census data still missing)
- **Permanent commission** constituted independently (like NCSC/NCST)
- Centre should carve **sub-categories DNT-SC, DNT-ST, and DNT-OBC** with **dedicated sub-quota** within existing reservations

Key Committees on DNTs

- ⇒ **Renke Commission (2008)** — documented DNT **socio-economic exclusion** in detail. Recommended permanent commission and repeal of Habitual Offenders Act.
- ⇒ **Idate Committee (2017-18)** — identified **809 Nomadic Tribes** and **334 Denotified Tribes** across India. Recommended sub-quotas within SC/ST/OBC.

Government Schemes for DNTs

1. **Dr. Ambedkar Pre-matric and Post-Matric Scholarship** for DNT Boys and Girls
2. **Nanaji Deshmukh Scheme of Construction of Hostels** for DNT Boys and Girls

3. **Assistance for Skill Development** of OBCs/DNTs/EBCs

Conclusion: DNTs continue to face stigma, exclusion, and economic hardship despite repeal of Criminal Tribes Act. True rehabilitation demands **de-stigmatisation, accurate identification, and targeted welfare measures**.

10. ROLE OF NGOS IN TRIBAL DEVELOPMENT (9.1)

Historical Evolution

- **Ancient times:** Rishis and sannyasins provided medicine, spirituality, ethical living guidance
- **British period:** Christian missionaries — education, healthcare, social reform in tribal areas (but with conversion agenda)
- **Post-independence:** Secular social organisations and NGOs emerged

World Bank definition of NGO: "Private organizations that pursue activities to relieve suffering, promote the interests of the poor, protect the environment, provide basic social services, or undertake community development." They are non-profit, function independently of government, and are also called **civil societies**.

Christianity as Early Agency

M.N. Srinivas observed that developmental activities by missionaries were viewed by Hindus as "**bait in the trap of conversion**" — creating suspicion around genuine welfare work.

Dhebar Commission noted: "In many places, the teachings of these missionaries have led to a **vertical division of society**" — splitting communities between converts and non-converts.

Key Social Workers and Voluntary Institutions

Organisation/Person	Contribution
A.V. Thakkar (Thakkar Bapa)	Established Bhil Seva Mandal in Gujarat; started 21 similar institutions for tribal welfare across India.
Dr. Rajendra Prasad	Founded Bharatiya Adimjati Sevak Sangh — "development of tribal communities with multidimensional view."
Ramakrishna Mission	Promotes welfare at national/state level; emphasis on character building ; explicitly free from proselytization .
Dhebar Commission	Proposed Forest Labourers Cooperatives in Gujarat and Maharashtra to prevent middleman exploitation.
Sarva Seva Sangh / Gandhi Smarak Nidhi	Emphasized Panchayat raj, prohibition, legal assistance for tribals.

4 Limitations of NGOs

1. Misuse and Misallocation of Funds

Shilu Ao Committee (1960): Highlighted financial irregularities and duplication of efforts. **NITI Aayog (2020)** and **CAG audits** continue to find gaps in financial accountability.

2. Non-compliance with FCRA Regulations

Under the **Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 2010**, between 2011-2023: over **12,000 NGOs** (including **Oxfam India**) lost foreign funding licences. The **Centre for Social Impact and Philanthropy (2022)** criticised these cancellations as tools of political control.

3. Perceived Hindrance to Economic Development

A classified **2014 Intelligence Bureau report** claimed that international NGOs (Greenpeace, Amnesty, ActionAid) reduced India's GDP by **2-3% annually** by opposing mining, infrastructure, and nuclear projects. However, this claim lacks empirical verification.

4. Lack of Transparency and Accountability

CAG report (2018): Less than **10%** of registered NGOs submitted annual reports or financial audits. No unified regulatory framework exists — responsibilities divided among NITI Aayog, Home Ministry (FCRA), State Charity Commissioners.

Case Studies on Tribal Welfare Interventions

A. Economic Interventions

⇒ NGO Case Studies:

Initiative	Location	Details
Horti-agro forestry for tribal women	Jawadhu Hills, Tamil Nadu	Additional income for single women families; men often migrate or lost to smuggling/alcohol.
Honey Co-operative (Arulagam NGO)	Nilgiris, Tamil Nadu	Sobha Madhan (Kurumba Adivasi, coordinator of NPVTG Federation); income from Rs 200-300/kg to Rs 1,000/kg by eliminating middlemen.
Piped Water Project (Maharashtra Prabhodhan Seva Mandal)	Surgana taluka, Nashik	Universal household water access; reduced women's workload of fetching water.

B. Social Interventions

Initiative	Location	Details
Sickle cell anaemia awareness (Synergy Sansthan)	Madhya Pradesh	Early detection and prevention among Saharia and Bhil communities.
"Period Homes" initiative	Fasli Tola, Gadchiroli, Maharashtra	Led by Sarpanch Tulavi; modern spaces replacing unsafe kurma huts where menstruating women were isolated; menstrual health awareness.

C. Human Rights

Bonded Labour Rescue (IJM — International Justice Mission): Rescued **24 bonded labourers including 10 children** from a brick kiln in **Sakleshpur, Hassan, Karnataka**. Workers had been trafficked from Krishnagiri, Tamil Nadu.

D. Cultural: Revival of Tribal Theatre (Natya Chetana)

Bhubaneswar-based NGO driving tribal theatre revival **since 1986**. Trained over **500 tribal youth** from Rayagada, Keonjhar, Mayurbhanj, Kandhamal districts. Staged **25 major plays** and **50+ cycle-theatre expeditions** from village to village. Challenges: artists drop out due to poverty, migration, lack of institutional support.

Conclusion: Grassroots NGOs are crucial for economic security, healthcare, gender dignity, and human rights in tribal areas. Success depends on **local participation, institutional support, and a rights-based approach**. NGOs complement official programmes with a **personal and culturally sensitive approach**.

11. ROLE OF ANTHROPOLOGY IN TRIBAL AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT (9.2)

Introduction

M.N. Srinivas (1972) at the Simla seminar stated: "I find today sharply increased awareness of the importance and urgency of associating sociologists and anthropologists in the solution of the many complex and baffling problems which confront the country today."

Why Anthropologists' Studies Help

Method	Contribution to Development
Cultural Relativism	Neutral perspective without preconceived notions; objective work that respects different cultural values.
Field Work / Participant Observation	Insider perspective — anthropologists become part of the society they study, gaining deep understanding unavailable through surveys alone.
Holistic Studies	Every aspect of society analyzed from multiple dimensions — economic, social, cultural, political, spiritual.
Integrated Studies	Understanding how different elements of society are interconnected — a change in one area affects all others.

Historical Background

Anthropologists' importance was first recognised by the **Court of Directors in 1807**. Early anthropologists like **Hutton, S.C. Roy, D.N. Majumdar, and Elwin** highlighted negative impacts of contact between tribal and non-tribal worlds — they were labelled "no changers", "revivalists", "isolationists" by their critics.

Post-independence: development policies did not adequately include anthropologists — benefits did not reach tribals effectively — this gap led to the emergence of **Applied Anthropology**.

Applied Anthropology

- ⇒ **John Van Willigen** — described applied anthropology as "**Anthropology put to use**".
- ⇒ **Kedia and Van Willigen** — defined applied anthropology as the application of anthropological methods and theory to the analysis and solution of practical problems.

Applied anthropology is sometimes called the "**fifth sub-field**" of anthropology (alongside cultural, physical, linguistic, and archaeological anthropology).

10 Key Anthropological Contributions to Tribal Development

1. Nature-Man-Spirit Complex

- ⇒ **L.P. Vidyarthi** — developed the concept of **Nature-Man-Spirit Complex**: the equilibrium between ecology (nature), social organization (man), and superhuman/spiritual component (spirit). Understanding this complex

helps plan tribal rehabilitation **with least resistance** — because disrupting any one element destabilizes the entire system.

2. Tribe-Caste Continuum

The concept of Tribe-Caste Continuum shows why it is **difficult to define tribes with specific, rigid criteria**. It reveals centuries of mutual influence between tribal and non-tribal communities — tribes are not isolated units but exist on a spectrum with caste society. This understanding is critical for designing policies that don't treat all tribes as homogeneous.

3. Integrationist Approach

Verrier Elwin's 'A Philosophy for NEFA' (1957, foreword by Nehru) became the foundation of India's tribal policy. Anthropological fieldwork and understanding directly shaped national policy — tribes would not be forced to give up their identity; choice would be left to tribals themselves.

4. Development of PVTG Category

Anthropologists contributed to the creation of the PVTG category in **1973** (renamed 2006) through: in-depth understanding of socio-economic marginalization, highlighting vulnerabilities invisible to statistical surveys, and advocating for targeted policies based on ethnographic evidence.

5. Tribal Sub Plan (TSP)

⇒ **Prof. S.C. Dube** — chaired the Expert Committee under Ministry of Education and Social Welfare, **1972**. TSP was adopted for the first time in the **Fifth Five-Year Plan**. Anthropologists highlighted the socio-economic and cultural distinctiveness of tribal communities that required separate planning.

6. Criminal Tribes Act Repeal and DNTs

Anthropologists provided understanding of the history, culture, and social dynamics of communities branded as "criminal tribes." They advocated that DNTs were citizens with equal rights — their involvement was crucial in building the intellectual case for repeal of CTA 1871 (repealed by Criminal Tribes Laws (Repeal) Act, 1952).

7. Forest Rights: B.K. Roy Burman Committee (1982)

Recognised that traditional forest-dwelling communities had **deep understanding of forest ecosystems**. Advocated **community-based forest management** and tribal rights over forest resources. This committee's work helped shape the **Forest Rights Act of 2006**.

8. Xaxa Committee Report (2014)

High-level committee headed by **Virginus Xaxa**, Professor at TISS. Submitted to PMO in May 2014. Addressed six thematic issues:

1. Livelihoods and employment status
2. Education
3. Health
4. Land alienation
5. Displacement and enforced migration
6. Legal/constitutional issues; delivery of public goods and services

Key recognitions: rights of tribals to refuse land acquisition; empowerment of gram sabha and tribal advisory council; rights of tribes in Scheduled Areas to mine minerals. The committee emphasized that tribal groups have **fallen behind over the last 60 years** despite India's rapid economic expansion.

9. Development of Tribal Health

⇒ **Dr. Abhay Bang** — Expert Committee on Tribal Health. Report: **"Tribal Health in India — Bridging the Gap and a Roadmap for the Future"** (first of its kind).

Key recommendations:

- Annual budget equal to **2.5% of GDP per capita** allocated for tribal healthcare (~INR 2500 per tribal in 2015-16)
- New entities: **Tribal Health Council** and **Directorate for Tribal Health** at state and union levels
- Government to focus **70% of resources on primary care**
- Adequate human resources and infrastructure in tribal areas

10. Safeguarding Endangered Languages

Anthropologists contribute by: conducting linguistic research and documentation of dying tribal languages, raising awareness about language endangerment, and advocating for language revitalization programs. Many tribal languages have fewer than 1,000 speakers — without documentation, they face extinction within a generation.

Role of Anthropology in Rural Development

Village Studies — Scholars and Works

Scholar	Work	Contribution
Robert Redfield	Work in Mexico	Initiated field work in villages; developed folk-urban continuum
William Wiser (1930s)	<i>Hindu Jajmani System; Behind the Mud Walls</i>	Pioneered rural India studies; documented economic interdependence of castes
D.N. Majumdar	<i>Caste and Communication in an Indian Village</i>	Impact of transport/communication on caste mobility
S.C. Dube	<i>Indian Village</i>	Classic village study — comprehensive ethnography of Shamirpet, Hyderabad
Oscar Lewis	Rural Cosmopolitanism	Challenged the idea of isolated, self-sufficient villages

Key Theoretical Concepts from Village Studies

Concept	Scholar
Dominant Caste	M.N. Srinivas
Sanskritization and Westernization	M.N. Srinivas
Little Republics	Charles Metcalfe
Rural Cosmopolitanism	Oscar Lewis
Little and Great Traditions	Robert Redfield
Universalization and Parochialization	McKim Marriott

Sacred Complex	L.P. Vidyarthi
Nature-Man-Spirit Complex	L.P. Vidyarthi

Application in Rural Development

Issue	Anthropological Contribution
Agrarian Social Structure	Ethnographic works showed how land relations, caste hierarchy, and ritual power interact. Inequality is rooted not just in economics but in cultural values and kinship obligations. This guided land reform, community development, and Panchayati Raj policies.
Left-Wing Extremism (Naxalism)	Micro-level accounts of deprivation among Santhal, Munda, Gond revealed systemic exploitation. Helped shape PESA (1996) and FRA (2006). Where political science saw rebellion, anthropology revealed cultural resistance — a deeper, identity-based struggle.
Regionalism	Demonstrated that regional movements arise from cultural neglect and symbolic exclusion, not just economic deprivation. Vidyarthi showed how sacred centres like Gaya unite diverse groups through rituals. Studies in Jharkhand and Northeast revealed that ignoring folk culture and language leads to identity mobilisation.

⇒ **David G. Mandelbaum (1990)** — wrote "**Anthropology and Challenges of Development**" — emphasized anthropology's holistic view and field work as essential tools for understanding development challenges that statistical approaches miss.

Conclusion: Anthropology's fieldwork tradition helped locate **channels of social change**, understand communication's role in breaking down caste prejudices, and identify emerging power structures. Applied Anthropology's participatory research methods and evidence-based recommendations have been acknowledged by global institutions including the **World Bank**.

12. COMMUNALISM (9.3)

Definition

⇒ **D.C. Smith (1979)** — defined communalism as: "An ideology based on the belief that society is divided into religious communities whose interests differ and are opposed to each other and hence **antagonistic in nature**."

Communalism is the antagonism practiced by people of one community against people of another community and religion. It converts religious identity into political identity and uses it for mobilization.

8 Factors Responsible for Communalism

1. Divisive Politics

Religion or cultural identity used to mobilize support. The "majority-minority divide" is consolidated for votes — weakening secular democracy. Political parties exploit communal sentiments during elections.

2. Politics of Appeasement

Shah Bano Case (1985-86): The Supreme Court upheld **Shah Bano's right to post-divorce maintenance** under secular law (Section 125 CrPC). However, the **Rajiv Gandhi government reversed the verdict** through the **Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Divorce) Act, 1986** — under pressure from conservative Muslim leadership. This is a textbook case of **vote-bank politics and state surrender to religious orthodoxy**. It alienated both reformist Muslims and secular Hindus.

3. Shift to Religious Mobilisation

Rath Yatra (1990): A large religious procession led by L.K. Advani from Gujarat to Ayodhya — mobilizing Hindu sentiment around the Ram Janmabhoomi issue. By **1992**: demolition of Babri Masjid — violence erupted from both sides across the country. This reflected the fragility of communal balance and showed how religious symbols could be weaponized for political ends.

4. Economic Causes

UN Multidimensional Poverty Index (2023): One in three Muslims in India is multidimensionally poor. Economic competition between Hindu and Muslim traders adds to distrust. Continued reliance on outdated madrasa education limits economic mobility for many Muslims.

5. Historical and Structural Factors

Communal tensions tend to **reappear in places with past history of conflict**. Delays in justice or administrative gaps allow small disputes to escalate. Historical grievances (Partition, demolition of religious structures) create a reservoir of resentment.

6. Psychological and Social Dimensions

Communalism is sustained by **social distance and fear**. It arises from misunderstanding and lack of inter-community communication. **Karnataka Anti-Conversion Bill (2021)**: Christian community protests

reflected perception and communication gaps between communities.

7. Role of Media and Social Media

Sensationalist coverage inflames tensions. **Delhi Riots (2020)**: Viral videos were used to spread anger and misinformation. Social media **nationalises local conflicts** — turning a neighbourhood dispute into a pan-India communal narrative within hours.

8. Communal Violence and Civic Ties

Saumitra Jha: Gujarat's medieval port towns with historic Hindu-Muslim trade ties were **25% less likely to experience riots in 2002** — shared economic interests created resilience against communal violence.

Ashutosh Varshney (2002): Shared **civic associations** (trade unions, professional bodies, festival committees) and **neighbourhood networks** reduce communal violence. Cities with strong inter-community associational life (like Calicut) had fewer riots than those without (like Aligarh).

4 Major Instances of Communal Violence

Event	Year	Details
Partition Riots	1947	~15 million displaced; close to 1 million lives lost. Trauma of divided homeland that continues to shape India-Pakistan relations.
Anti-Sikh Riots	1984	After assassination of PM Indira Gandhi; thousands of Sikhs killed; gurdwaras destroyed. State machinery accused of complicity.
Gujarat Riots	2002	Sabarmati Express attacked at Godhra (59 Hindu pilgrims killed) — retaliatory violence across state. Thousands killed and displaced.
Kandhamal Violence	2008	Odisha. After killing of Swami Laxmanananda Saraswati; Maoists claimed responsibility but Christian communities were attacked in retaliation.

Features of Communal Riots (Findings from Last 5 Decades)

- More **politically motivated than fuelled by religion**
- Besides political interests, **economic interests** play a vigorous part
- More common in **North India** than South and East
- **Possibility of recurrence is stronger** in towns where riots have already occurred
- Most take place during **religious festivals** when emotions are heightened
- Use of **deadly weapons** is on the ascendancy

Overall Assessment

India has 1.4 billion people of diverse faiths — **99% coexist harmoniously** every day. India's civilisational philosophy of tolerance is reflected in Vedas, Upanishads, Buddha, Mahavira, Sufis, and Bhakti saints. Communal incidents are **exceptions rather than the rule**.

Concluding Philosophy: India is a land of rich diversities — **"We're all minorities in India"**. The great Indian secret is **"acceptance of difference rather than mere tolerance."**

Rig Veda: *"Ekam Sat Vipra bahudha vadanti"* — **"There is only one truth and learned persons call it by many names."**

QUICK-REVISION CHEAT SHEET

Topic 1: Impact of Hinduism

- 90-95% tribals Hinduised | Peasantization (N.K. Bose) | Gotras more totemistic than Vedic = Tribe-Caste Continuum
- Tribe-Rajput Continuum (Surajit Sinha, Bhumij) | Kshatriyaization = Sanskritization (Tharu, Khasa)
- Bhil case study: Parvati was Bhil, killed Nandi, cursed to poverty, boon = theft no sin
- **5 Positive:** Cultural integration, deity absorption, agriculture, literacy, religious tolerance
- **6 Negative:** Brahmin dependence, youth dormitory decline (Ghotul/Dhumkuria), dowry, child marriage, caste hierarchy, cultural autonomy loss

Topic 2: Impact of Christianity

- 2nd largest religion among tribes | NE has highest concentration | Colonial-era missionaries
- **7 Positive:** Early welfare, education/scripts (Lorrain, Hoffmann, Bodding), Westernization, harmful practice elimination, health, alcohol prohibition (YMA), syncretism (religious layering — Elwin)
- **8 Negative:** Ethnocentric, superiority (K.N. Sahay), demographic change, institution loss (Morung/Ghotul), gender impact (mixed), socio-economic neglect (Khasi divisions), revivalism (Donyi-Polo, Sarna, Gond Mahasabha), political identity
- Scholars: K.N. Sahay, Tanka Bahadur Subba, Nirmal Minz, Andre Beteille, Verrier Elwin

Topic 3: Impact of Buddhism

- 0.5% tribal population | Mauryan-Kushan spread | Way of life, not rigid religion
- 5 case studies: Bhutia (Vajrayana), Lepcha (Bon syncretism), Chakma (Theravada), Monpa/Sherdukpen (Mahayana), Brokpa/Changpa (Lha/Yul-Iha)
- Furer-Haimendorf: Buddhist converts didn't renounce tribal rituals | Symbiotic not replacement
- Result: Syncretic evolution, limited but significant impact

Topic 4: Impact of Islam

- Dogmatic nature limited spread | Sufi saints main agents | Groups: Siddi, Gujjar, Bakarwal, Lakshadweep
- Taravad: matrilineal unit, ancestress descent, female property, male usufructuary rights
- Duolocal residence (Hanson) | Easy divorce = high divorce frequency | Gradual shift to patriliney
- Scholars: K.S. Singh (Southern Arabia), Leela Dube and Kutty (matriliney), Aiyappan (not tribals), Hanson (duolocal)
- 3 Negative impacts: kinship erosion, ritual decline, dual marginalisation (Gujjar/Bakarwal)

Topic 5: Tribe and Nation State

- Definitions: Tribe (Majumdar), Nation (Eller), State (Weber — monopoly on violence), Nation State (congruent)
- ILO 169: Subjective (self-identification) + Objective criteria | India: indigenous vs settlers NOT valid
- 3 Challenges: identity/culture, self-governance, colonization legacy
- 5 types Native American governance | Stolen Generations (Australia, 1910-70, 100,000 children)

Topic 6: Approaches to Tribal Development

- **Isolationist:** Elwin 1939, National Park Theory | Criticism: romantic, anthropological museums | Ex: US reservations
- **Assimilationist:** Ghurye + Thakkar Bapa, "backward Hindus" | Criticism: ethnocentric, top-down | Ex: Stolen Generations
- **Integrationist:** Elwin 1957, Nehru, salad bowl, choice left to tribals | India's approach
- **Tribal Panchsheel (5):** Non-imposition, land/forest rights, tribal leadership, simple admin, human growth
- UNDRIP: Art 8 (against forced assimilation), Art 5 (retain institutions + participate in state)
- Fisher v. University of Texas 2016 — race as factor, no workable alternative

Topic 7: Administration History

- **British (4 reasons):** Security, economic, cultural justification, missionary access
- Malers/Paharias case study: Cleveland ring-fence, Daman-e-Koh, Reg I of 1796
- 5 uprisings: Ho 1831, Khond 1846, Santhal 1855, Angami 1879, Abor/Lushai 1880-1910
- Laws: Scheduled District Act 1874, GoI Act 1919 (wholly/partially excluded), GoI Act 1935
- **Post-independence:** Art 342, 366(25), 244 | Fifth and Sixth Schedule | TSP (5th FYP, S.C. Dube)

Topic 8: PVTGs

- 75 PVTGs out of 705 STs | Dhebar Commission 1973 (PTGs) — renamed 2006 (PVTGs)
- Criteria: forest-dependent, pre-agriculture, declining population, low literacy, subsistence economy
- Largest: Saharia (4+ lakhs) | Declining: Onge, Andamanese (inbreeding) | Stagnant: Birhor
- FRA: Section 3(1)(e) habitat rights, Section 2(h) habitat definition
- Bonded labour: Saharia (Hali system), Juangs (goti system) | Bonded Labour Act 1976

Topic 9: Denotified Tribes

- CTA 1871: 150-200 communities, "hereditary criminals", genetic crime notion
- Repealed 1952 | Replaced by Habitual Offenders Act 1951 | Aug 31 = DNT Independence Day
- Banjaras anomaly: ST/SC/OBC/DNT depending on state
- 6 challenges | Renke Commission 2008, Idate Committee 2017-18 (809 NT + 334 DNT)

- Scholars: Dilip D'Souza, A.P. Jithender Reddy, Ayyangar Committee

Topic 10: NGOs

- Evolution: Rishis — missionaries — secular NGOs | Srinivas: "bait in trap of conversion"
- Key workers: Thakkar Bapa (Bhil Seva Mandal), Dr. Rajendra Prasad (Adimjati Sevak Sangh), Ramakrishna Mission
- 4 limitations: fund misuse, FCRA non-compliance, perceived GDP hindrance, transparency gaps
- Case studies: Jawadhu Hills, Arulagam honey co-op, IJM bonded labour rescue, Natya Chetana theatre

Topic 11: Role of Anthropology

- Methods: Cultural relativism, participant observation, holistic studies, integrated studies
- Applied Anthropology = "Anthropology put to use" (Van Willigen) | "Fifth sub-field"
- **10 contributions:** Nature-Man-Spirit (Vidyarthi), Tribe-Caste Continuum, Integrationist approach, PVTGs, TSP (S.C. Dube), CTA repeal, Forest rights (Roy Burman 1982), Xaxa Committee 2014, Tribal Health (Abhay Bang), Endangered languages
- Village studies: Redfield, Wiser, Majumdar, S.C. Dube, Oscar Lewis
- Concepts: Dominant Caste, Sanskritization, Little Republics, Sacred Complex, Nature-Man-Spirit
- Rural applications: agrarian structure, LWE (cultural resistance), regionalism

Topic 12: Communalism

- Definition: D.C. Smith 1979 — ideology of antagonistic religious communities
- **8 factors:** Divisive politics, appeasement (Shah Bano 1985), religious mobilisation (Rath Yatra 1990), economic causes, historical/structural, psychological, media/social media, civic ties
- **4 riots:** Partition 1947, Anti-Sikh 1984, Gujarat 2002, Kandhamal 2008
- Features: politically motivated, economic interests, North India focus, recurrence pattern, during festivals, deadly weapons
- Saumitra Jha: trade ties = 25% less riots | Varshney: civic associations reduce violence
- 99% coexist | "Ekam Sat Vipra bahudha vadanti" | Acceptance over tolerance

All Handwritten Annotations Index (37+ entries)

Scholar/Concept	Topic
Surajit Sinha — Tribe Rajput Continuum (Bhumij)	Hinduism
S.K. Srivastav — Tharu tribe	Hinduism
D.N. Majumdar — Khasa tribe; tribe definition	Hinduism, Nation State
V.R. Elwin — Ghotul/Dhumkuria decline; religious layering; Baiga 1939; NEFA 1957	Hinduism, Christianity, Approaches
Tanka Bahadur Subba — conversions for education/welfare	Christianity

K.N. Sahay — Christian Oraon superiority; missionaries as earliest welfare	Christianity
Nirmal Minz — Christian Oraons honored ancestral spirits	Christianity
Andre Beteille — conversion = reformulation of identity	Christianity
C. von Furer-Haimendorf — Buddhist converts kept tribal rituals	Buddhism
K.S. Singh — Islam from Southern Arabia to Lakshadweep	Islam
Leela Dube and Kutty (1969) — Lakshadweep matriliney	Islam
Aiyappan — islanders not tribals, like Moplahs	Islam
Hanson — duolocal residence pattern	Islam
Lucy Mair — tribe as independent political division	Nation State
Eller — defined nation	Nation State
Max Weber — state monopoly on legitimate violence	Nation State
Thakkar Bapa — criticized isolationism; promoted assimilation	Approaches
Robert J. Miller — Native American reservation poverty	Approaches
Thakkar Bapa and G.S. Ghurye — assimilationist, "backward Hindus"	Approaches
UNDRIP — Articles 8 and 5	Approaches
Prof. S.C. Dube — TSP Expert Committee 1972	Administration
Dhebar Commission — created PTGs 1973	PVTGs
Xaxa Committee — PVTG identification criteria	PVTGs
Sahariya — bonded labour, Hali system (Rajasthan)	PVTGs
Anumena Yadav — goti system (Jharkhand, Odisha)	PVTGs
Dr. Abhay Bang — Tribal Health Expert Committee	PVTGs/Anthropology
Dilip D'Souza — colonial law criminalizing communities	DNTs
A.P. Jithender Reddy — repeal alone won't fix DNTs	DNTs
Ananthasayanam Ayyangar Committee — CTA repeal	DNTs
Renke Commission (2008) — DNT socio-economic exclusion	DNTs
Idate Committee (2017-18) — 809 NT + 334 DNT	DNTs
Banjaras — classification anomaly across states	DNTs
John Van Willigen — "Anthropology put to use"	Anthropology
Kedia and Van Willigen — defined applied anthropology	Anthropology
L.P. Vidyarthi — Nature-Man-Spirit Complex, Sacred Complex	Anthropology
David G. Mandelbaum (1990) — Anthropology and Challenges of Development	Anthropology
D.C. Smith (1979) — communalism definition	Communalism